



Acholi Private Sector Development Company Ltd

Promoting business excellence that sustainably meets the needs of private-sector growth and development in Uganda.

Institutional Capacity Building

Business Development

Microfinance Support

Agribusiness development

Gender Programming

Social Research

Policy Advocacy

WHO WE ARE

Acholi Private Sector Development Company Limited (APSEDEC) — formerly the Kitgum Private Sector Promotion Centre — is a National capacity-building and business-development organisation established in June 1999 as a project under the Government of Uganda and UNDP Country Cooperation Framework (CCF I). It was registered in June 2004 by the Registrar of Companies as a Company Limited by Guarantee (Registration No. 62106).

Headquartered in Kitgum with field offices in Gulu, Pader, Kaabong, Kaseses, Kalangala, Buvuma and Mayuge. APSEDEC has more than 25 years of continuous operations delivering enterprise development, microfinance, agribusiness, financial inclusion and gender-transformative programming for smallholder farmers, women and youth. The company is governed by a Board of Directors democratically elected from a membership of 26 private-sector, public-sector and civil-society organisations, and is led day-to-day by the Chief Executive Officer.

VISION & MISSION

Vision: To be a centre of business excellence that sustainably meets the needs of private sector growth and development.

Mission: To offer client-oriented capacity-building services in enterprise and entrepreneurship growth and development, business development service & management, microfinance support services, research & advocacy, and fostering strategic alliances with development partners for increased incomes and sustainable livelihoods.

CORE VALUES

- Mutual Respect
- Accountability
- Team Work
- Professionalism
- God Fearing

WHAT WE DO

- Business Development Services for individual, group and farmer-association enterprises in the public and private sectors.
- Microfinance support — Financial Inclusion through formation, training and digitalisation of VSLAs, SACCOs and MFIs in governance, operations, products and systems.
- Agribusiness and value-chain development, farmer institutional development, cooperative formation and market linkages.
- Gender-transformative programming, research, monitoring & evaluation and policy advocacy.

OUR REACH

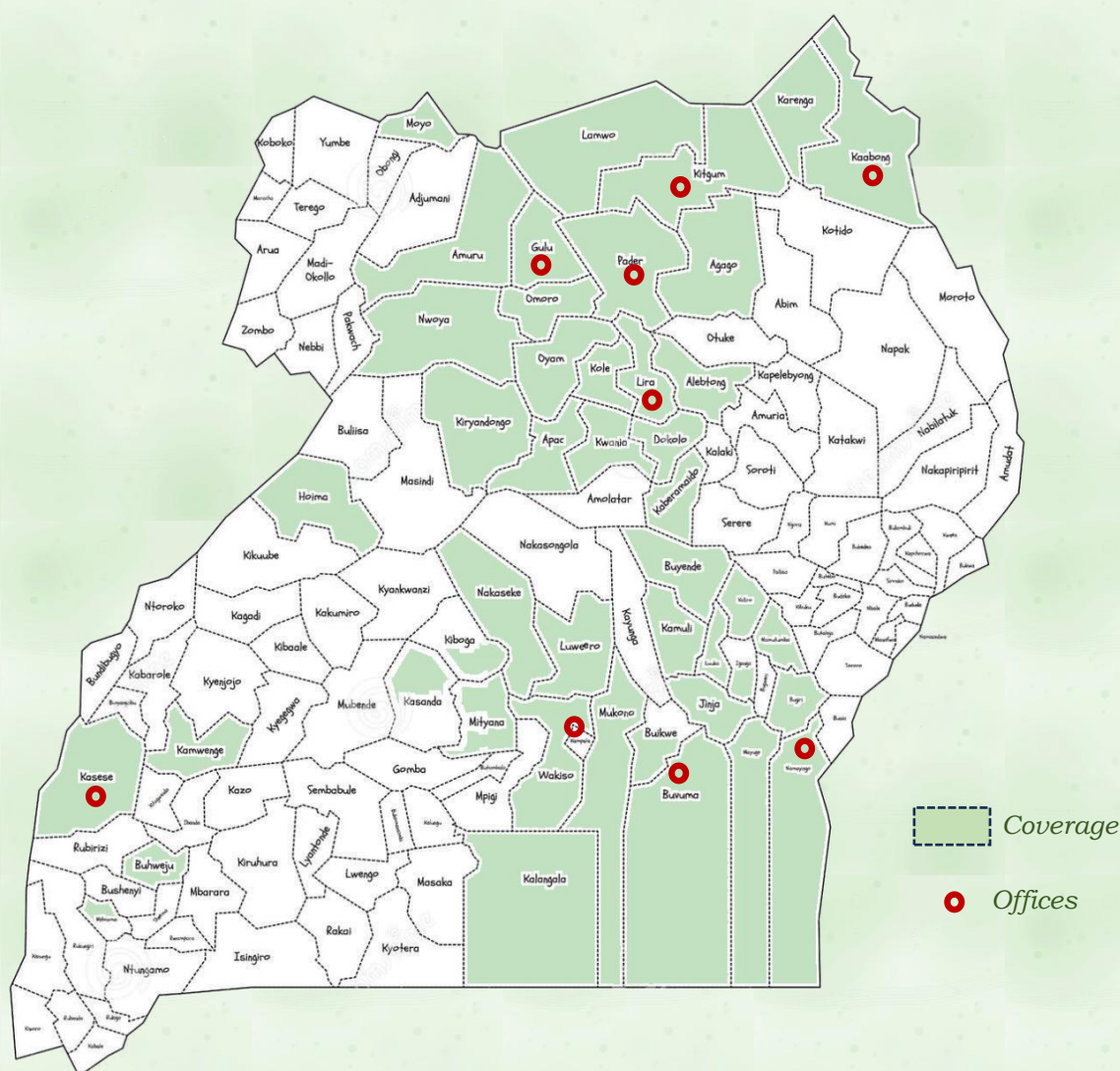
25+ Years of operations	70,000+ Farmers & women supported	8,000+ VSLAs formed / strengthened	40+ Districts reached nationwide
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Major donors & partners: IFAD, CARE International in Uganda, World Bank, USAID, UNDP, CARE International, UNCDF, UNHCR, NWSC, MAAIF, MoFPED, GOAL, RTI, TechnoServe, World Education/Bantwana, FSDU.

WHERE WE ARE

APSEDEC has implemented development program in nearly 50 districts across Uganda – creating strong lasting partnerships with the local governments in those districts. Active projects are in Northern, Eastern, Central and West Nile regions covering 15 districts.

Map of Uganda showing areas APSEDEC has presence.



PROJECT PORTFOLIO

Over more than two decades APSEDEC has implemented a broad portfolio of capacity-building, financial-inclusion and agribusiness projects across the Acholi, Lango, West Nile, Busoga, Central, Karamoja and Western regions of Uganda — several delivered in consortium with partner firms. The current and recent engagements are summarised below, followed by earlier completed projects.

CURRENT & RECENT PROJECTS (2021 – 2026)

Her Money, Her Life (HMHL) Agrifund

CARE International • 8 months (May – Dec 2026) • Acholi & Lango sub-regions

Northern Uganda implementation node of CARE International's multi-country Her Money, Her Life Agrifund (with Bloomberg Philanthropies and the Women's Economic Development Network), transitioning low-income women from informal activity into market-oriented collective enterprises through savings-led inclusion, enterprise development and gender-norms change across seven milestones. Value chains: oilseeds, maize, coffee and hibiscus.

Scale & reach: APSEDEC component — 150 VSLAs strengthened, 150 collective marketing committees, 25 PMGs/aggregation hubs formalised, 50 women leaders mentored; contract ceiling ≈ UGX 444M (the wider programme targets 30,000 women directly).



Advancing Women Collective Enterprises in Markets (AWCEM)

CARE International • 19 months (Feb 2026 – Aug 2027) • 8 districts, Acholi sub-region

Research-driven CARE programme designing, testing and scaling inclusive market-aggregation and credit models for low-income, women-led enterprises, building on prior DREAMS and DDT4C programming. Value chains: groundnuts, hibiscus, seed oils and shea butter.

Scale & reach: APSEDEC component — 331 women's groups (6,620 women entrepreneurs) and 50 women business mentors across 8 Northern Uganda districts (the wider programme targets 12,000 women across 600 VSLAs in Uganda).



National Oilseeds Project (NOSP)

IFAD / MAAIF • 3 years (from May 2026) • Busoga sub-region

CONSORTIUM: SEPSPEL–APSEDEC Joint Venture (with South Eastern Private Sector Promotion Enterprise Ltd)

Agribusiness Development Service Provision to commercialise the oilseed value chain through farmer institutional development, agricultural extension, financial inclusion, market-systems strengthening and inclusive agribusiness across the eleven Busoga districts of Namayingo, Bugiri, Jinja, Iganga, Mayuge, Bugweri, Buyende, Namutumba, Kaliro, Luuka and Kamuli.

Scale & reach: 630 farmer groups and 18,175 farming households targeted over the three-year period.



NOPP – Strengthening Oil Palm Farmers' Organisations (NOPP-FID)

IFAD / MAAIF • 5 years (from Feb 2022) • Buvuma & Mayuge hubs

Under the National Oil Palm Project, formation and strengthening of Oil Palm Growers' Organisations (OPGOs) and their finance arms (SACCOs) for sustainable service delivery — a three-year formation phase followed by two years of monitoring and sustainability. Hubs cover Buvuma plus Mayuge, Namayingo and Bugiri districts.

Scale & reach: Four cooperatives formed and registered (Buvuma OPGO and the Mayuge, Namayingo & Bugiri District OPGOs); ≈ 2,750 oil-palm grower members mobilised across the two hubs, with SACCO development underway.



NOPP – Livelihood Diversification & Resilience (NOPP Component 2)

IFAD / MAAIF • ≈ Oct 2023 – Aug 2025 • Kalangala & Buvuma

Business development services promoting self-employment, small-scale entrepreneurship, vocational skilling and rural finance for oil-palm and non-oil-palm households, helping youth and women diversify their livelihoods through profitable enterprises and savings groups.

Scale & reach: 1,150 beneficiaries (50% women, 50% youth) trained in entrepreneurship and vocational skills, with operational business plans, profitable enterprises and 56 VSLAs formed.



Integrated Water Management & Development Project (IWMDP – LOT 3)

World Bank / GoU via NWSC • Nov 2024 – Mar 2026 • Oitino Catchment, Gulu City

Alternative-livelihood support under the full-scale source-protection measures for the Oitino (Oyitino) catchment — supply of inputs and enterprise infrastructure, community mobilisation, VSLA formation and skilling in poultry and piggery enterprises. All deliverables completed.

Scale & reach: 300 direct beneficiaries (57% female, 30% youth, 12% PWDs) from 10 VSLAs. 100 enterprise units constructed (50 poultry houses, 50 pig sties); 9,000 birds and 65 pigs distributed.



Capacity Building of Mt. Otce Metu SACCO FSD Uganda – Affirmative Action MSE Recovery Fund • from Oct 2024 • Moyo District

Technical capacity-building of Mount Otce Metu Savings and Credit Society (Metu Trading Centre, Metu Subcounty) to meet MSE Recovery Fund eligibility — strengthening corporate governance, financial performance, credit and risk management, and information systems using the STAR approach.

Scale & reach: Metu SACCO serves 7,908 members and 1,516 active loan clients on a loan book of UGX 2.3 billion.



Agriculture Value Chain Development Programme (AVCP)

GoU / MAAIF / African Development Bank • 2 years (Nov 2021 – Oct 2023) • 15 districts, Central & Western Uganda

CONSORTIUM: APSEDEC Consortium with the International Institute of Rural Reconstruction (IIRR)

Technical agricultural extension and agribusiness development for the maize and rice value chains — farmer institutional development, farming-as-a-business, post-harvest handling, local seed business, the Village Agent Model and VSLAs across Buhweju, Mitooma, Kasese, Kamwenge, Kyegegwa, Kiryandongo, Masindi, Buikwe, Buvuma, Kiboga, Mukono, Nakaseke, Luwero, Mityana and Wakiso.

Scale & reach: 14,591 farmer groups (≈ 323,868 members) reached and 1,462 Village Agents established; 91% of cumulative deliverables achieved.



DREAMS – Deliver Women's Economic Resilience through Enterprises & Market Systems

CARE International / Gates Foundation • 1 year (Nov 2024 – Sep 2025) • Acholi sub-region (Gulu, Kitgum, Nwoya, Omoro)

Upskilling assignment under CARE International's DREAMS programme (Gates Foundation; with MGLSD, MoFPED, UWEAL, PostBank and UMRA) — mentoring women entrepreneurs to transition from informal to micro and small enterprises through enterprise-specific skills, financial management, record-keeping, business development, digital literacy, market linkages, value addition and gender-norms household dialogues.

Scale & reach: 3,537 women entrepreneurs targeted across Gulu City, Gulu, Kitgum, Nwoya and Omoro; 3,197 (90%) mentored and trained, with 8 of 19 result areas exceeding target.

EARLIER PROJECTS (2016 – 2021)

Project for Financial Inclusion in Rural Areas (PROFIRA)

MoFPED / IFAD • 2016 – 2021 (Phases 2.1 & 2.2) • Acholi & Lango sub-regions

CONSORTIUM: *Mid-North Private Sector Development Company (MNPSDC) and IIRR*

Establishment and strengthening of Community Savings and Credit Groups (CSCGs/VSLAs) to expand rural financial inclusion — Phase 2.1 Part 1 (Apr 2016–Apr 2019), Phase 2.1 Part 2 and the mature-group 'Strengthening, Innovations & Partnerships' Phase 2.2 (Dec 2018–Dec 2021), with financial literacy, business skills and bank linkages.

Scale & reach: 3,486 CSCGs with 59,726 members trained in both phase 1 & Phase 2 plus 211 mature CSCGs (5,680 members) strengthened.



Vegetable Oil Development Program – Phase 2 (VODP2)

MAAIF / GoU / IFAD • Oct 2016 – Dec 2019 • Agago & Nwoya

Capacity-building of oilseed farmer groups and Secondary Farmer Organisations to raise production and productivity of sunflower, soybean and related oil crops, with demos, collective marketing, seed multiplication and VSLA promotion.

Scale & reach: 200 farmer groups with 6,071 members; 185 groups benefited from demonstrations across 25 acres.



Producer Organization Activity (POA)

TechnoServe / USAID Feed the Future • 2017 – Mar 2020 • Gulu, Lira & Masindi

Business Development Services to transform Producer Organisations into viable, sustainable business entities supplying quality coffee, maize and beans — governance, records management, AGMs, input supply and market linkages.

Scale & reach: 4 Producer Organisations strengthened; secured 2 tractors via NAADS and UGX 180M from SNV, with multi-tonne produce supply contracts signed.



Governance, Accountability, Participation & Performance (GAPP)

RTI / USAID / UKAid • Mar 2017 – Jun 2019 • Gulu, Kitgum & Pader

Enhancing private-sector participation in local governance for improved service delivery — strengthening the internal governance and advocacy capacity of Private Sector Associations and convening district-level dialogues, delivered across 16 phased milestones.

Scale & reach: 15 Private Sector Associations representing 450 members; all 16 milestones completed.



Adolescent Youth Education & Development Initiative (AYEDI)

World Education / Bantwana • Aug 2016 – Apr 2018 • Gulu & Lira

Soft-skills training, business mentorship and household agribusiness support for out-of-school adolescent youth (15–17 years) engaged in or at risk of hazardous labour, enabling decent work and self-employment.

Scale & reach: More than 900 youth and their household members supported, with 255 trained in alternative enterprises and 780 households establishing backyard gardens.



COVID-19 Resilience & Recovery Program (CRRP)

GOAL Uganda • Aug 2020 – Aug 2021 • Agago, Kaabong & Karenga

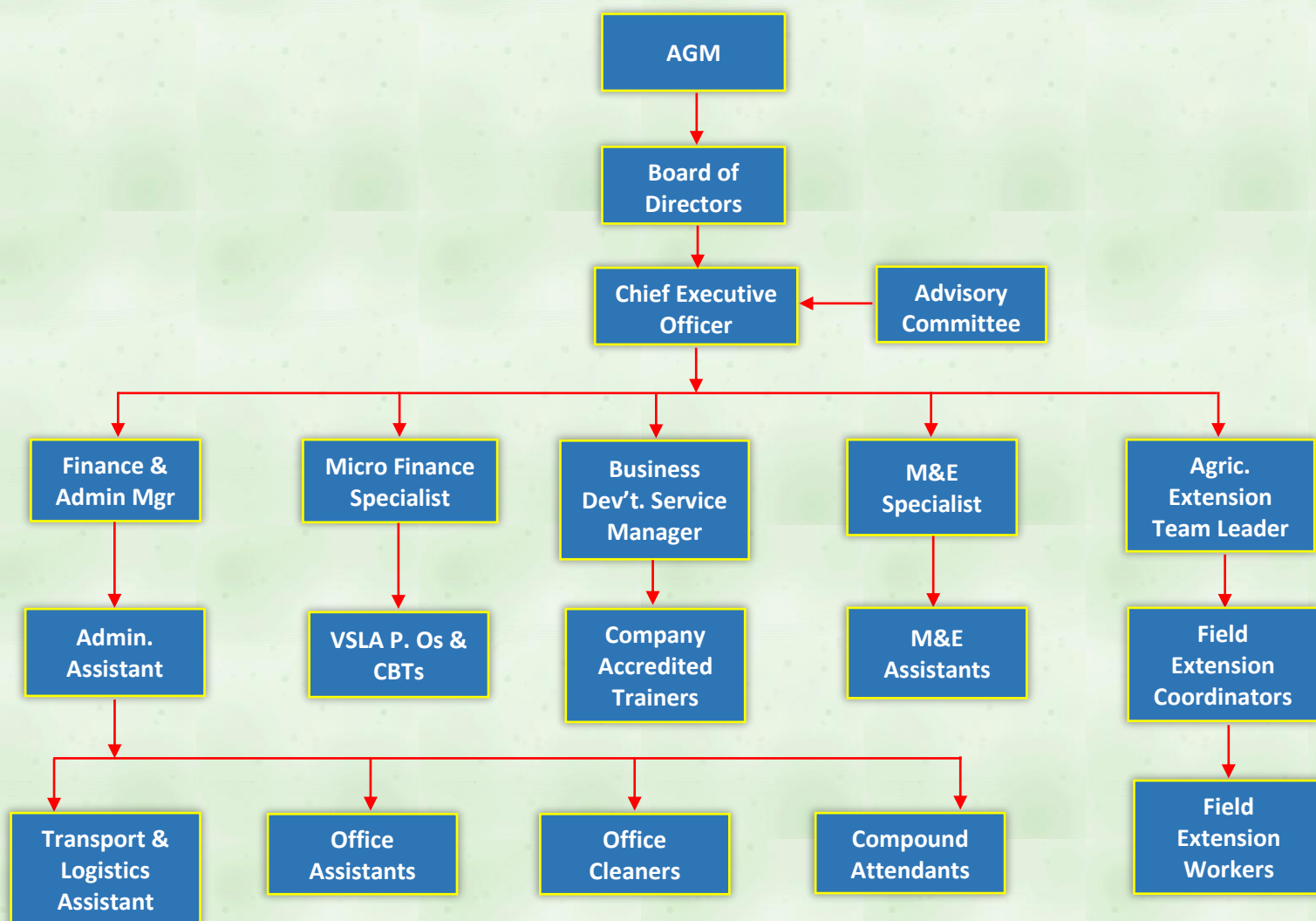
Business development support to help rural young women and men reconfigure on- and off-farm livelihoods and recover from COVID-19 economic shocks — entrepreneurship and financial-literacy training, VSLA strengthening, registration and financial linkages.

Scale & reach: 1,000 youth-owned MSEs (70% women-owned) and 400 VSLAs strengthened across three districts.



GOVERNANCE & LEADERSHIP

APSEDEC is governed by a Board of Directors drawn from its private-, public- and voluntary-sector membership, chaired by Mr. Ogwang Daniel Abwa, with the Chief Executive Officer, Mr. Nelson Tasenga, leading the management team — Finance & Administration, Business Development, Microfinance and M&E Specialists, supported by agribusiness trainers, gender practitioners, M&E officers and a network of accredited Community-Based Trainers and Facilitators.



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